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ECONOMIC SURVEYS BY THE OECD

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IRELAND

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MARCH 1963

ORGANISATION FOR ECONOMIC
CO-OPERATION AND DEVELOPMENT

PARIS

IRELAND

BASIC STATISTICS

THE LAND

Area (thousand sq. km.)	70
Agricultural area (av. 1956-57/1959-60) as % of total area	67

Population of major cities (including suburbs), 1961 Census.	
Dublin	593,000
Cork	116,000
Dun Laoghaire	68,000
Limerick	51,000

THE PEOPLE

Population (April 1961)	2,815,000
Number of inhabitants per sq. km.	40
Decrease in population:	
Annual average 1956-61	16,700
Natural increase in population:	
Annual average 1956-61	26,400

Emigration:	
Annual average 1956-61	43,100
Annual average per thousand of population	15
Labour force, total at work, April 1961	1,119,000
Employment in:	
— Agriculture, forestry and fishing	409,000
— Industry	220,000
— Construction	64,000

PRODUCTION

Gross national product in 1961 (£ million)	697
GNP per head (U.S. dollars)	694
Gross fixed investment (average 1957-61):	
— as % of GNP	14
— per head (U.S. dollars)	84

Origin of gross domestic product in 1961:	
— Agriculture, forestry and fishing	25
— Industry	30
— Services	45

THE GOVERNMENT

Public current expenditure on goods and services, 1961 (as % of GNP)	12
General government current revenue, 1961 (as % of GNP)	25
Public debt, 31st March 1962 (as % of central government current revenue)	283

Composition of Parliament (1961):	
Fianna Fail	70 seats
Fine Gael	47 seats
Labour	16 seats
Others	11 seats

Last elections: October 1961.

LIVING STANDARDS

Food consumption, calories per head per day (1961)	3,444
Average weekly earnings of industrial workers in September 1962 (in shillings)	180
Public current expenditure on education per head, in U.S. dollars (1960-61)	17

No. of passenger cars in use per thousand of population (1960)	62
No. of telephones per thousand of population (1961)	57
No. of radio sets per thousand of population (1961)	174

FOREIGN TRADE

Exports:	
Exports of goods and services as % of GNP (average 1957-61)	37
Main exports, 1961 (% of total domestic exports):	
Live cattle	25
Beef and veal	12
Textile manufactures	4
Clothing	4
Beer	4
Bacon	4
Main customers, 1961 (% of total):	
United Kingdom	74
United States	8
European Economic Community	6

Imports:	
Imports of goods and services as % of GNP (average 1957-61)	39
Main imports 1961 (% of total):	
Machinery and electrical goods	12
Textile fibres and manufactures	10
Vehicles	10
Chemicals	5
Petroleum	4
Main suppliers, 1961 (% of total):	
United Kingdom	51
European Economic Community	14
United States	8

THE CURRENCY

Monetary unit: Irish pound.

Currency unit per U.S. dollar. 0.357

ECONOMIC SURVEYS BY THE OECD

IRELAND

1963

ORGANISATION FOR ECONOMIC
CO-OPERATION AND DEVELOPMENT

The Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development was set up under a Convention signed in Paris on 14th December 1960 by the Member countries of the Organisation for European Economic Co-operation and by Canada and the United States. This Convention provides that the O.E.C.D. shall promote policies designed:

- *to achieve the highest sustainable economic growth and employment and a rising standard of living in Member countries, while maintaining financial stability, and thus to contribute to the development of the world economy;*
- *to contribute to sound economic expansion in Member as well as non-member countries in the process of economic development;*
- *to contribute to the expansion of world trade on a multilateral, non-discriminatory basis in accordance with international obligations.*

The legal personality possessed by the Organisation for European Economic Co-operation continues in the O.E.C.D., which came into being on 30th September 1961.

The Members of O.E.C.D. are: Austria, Belgium, Canada, Denmark, France, the Federal Republic of Germany, Greece, Iceland, Ireland, Italy, Luxembourg, the Netherlands, Norway, Portugal, Spain, Sweden, Switzerland, Turkey, the United Kingdom and the United States.

This document was approved
by the Economic and Development Review Committee
in March 1963

IRELAND

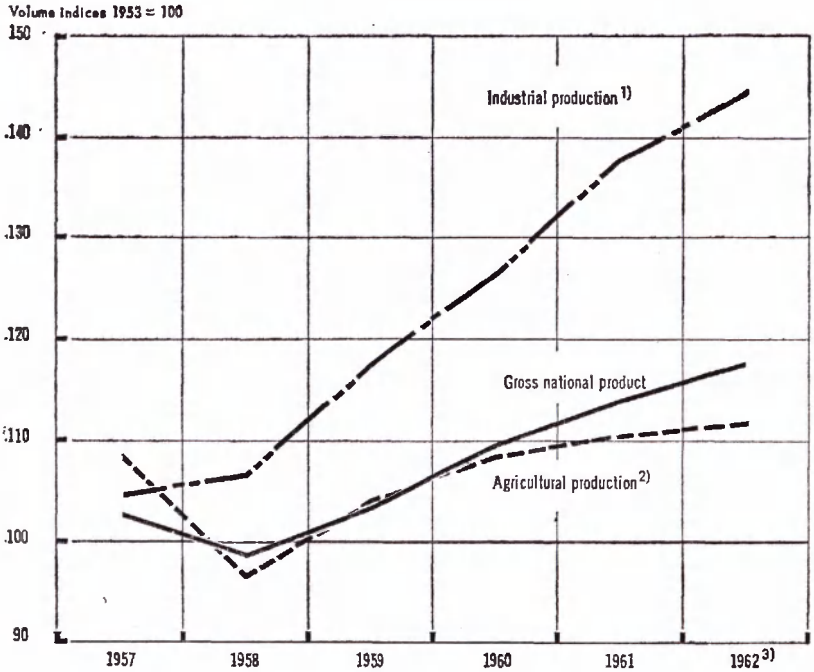
Introduction

1. The growth of the Irish economy, fairly rapid since 1958, continued in 1962 although rather more slowly. Maintenance of a growth rate of 4 ½ per cent a year on average has entailed the need to encourage businessmen and farmers to adopt more efficient ways of production and marketing and to expand their sales abroad. Since the Programme for Economic Expansion was initiated in 1958, there seems to have been some underlying strengthening of the balance of payments. Although the merchandise trade gap has widened, particularly in 1962 when a number of exceptional factors contributed to a weakening of exports, the biggest factor has been the rise in imports of capital equipment and raw materials. The structure of exports has reflected the progressive diversification of the economy as sales of manufactured products have risen markedly. The invisible balance has improved steadily and the capital account has improved owing to direct investment from abroad. At the end of 1962 the reserves stood at the high level of £234 million, equal to about the value of ten months' imports, and £28 million more than at the end of 1958.

2. The new impetus given to economic growth in recent years has been achieved without giving rise to excess demand conditions. Thus there is scope for the continued advance called for if Irish living standards — not high by comparison with a number of other European countries — are to go on rising. But this objective may become more difficult to achieve in the immediate future: in particular, an approximate balance needs to be maintained between the rise in incomes and productivity so as to allow room for higher investment and keep the external account in reasonable equilibrium. The Irish authorities are aware of these problems, which they intend to deal with in the framework of the second Programme for Economic Expansion which is to begin next year.

3. This report deals, first, with the current economic situation in the light of developments in 1962 and the prospects for 1963. The second part is devoted to an assessment of the major issues for economic policy raised by the need to maintain the balanced growth of the economy.

Diagram 1. TRENDS IN OUTPUT



1. Transportable goods.
2. Net output, excluding turf, but including stock changes.
3. Estimated.

Source: National Income and Expenditure 1961, and Irish Trade Journal and Statistical Bulletin.

I. Current Trends and Prospects

4. Total output probably rose by 3 to 3 ½ per cent in 1962, rather less than in 1961 when the rise was 4 per cent, and notably less than 6 and 5 per cent increases achieved in 1960 and 1959 respectively. The slowing down of the expansion can partly be explained by the fact that with market conditions abroad less favourable for industrial products, manufacturing output rose by 5 per cent, or about half the rise of 1961. Moreover, supply factors made for reduced cattle and beef exports, while weather conditions were bad for wheat (they affected peat production also) so that, overall, it is unlikely that there was any significant change in agricultural production. On the other hand, there was a marked rise in building and construction; even though the volume of gross fixed capital formation rose less than during the previous year, it still showed an 8 per cent increase.

a) *Incomes and Demand*

5. Personal incomes outside agriculture rose faster in 1962 mainly because of the wage and salary increases obtained at the end of 1961 and in early 1962. This rise is estimated to have been of the order of 12 per cent. Even allowing for the fact that eighteen months had elapsed since the previous wage round, the increase in earnings was considerably higher than the average annual rise in productivity of about 5 per cent in recent years. Part of the rise was absorbed by higher prices and savings also increased. Incomes in agriculture are expected to have risen only slightly, while the growth of profits is likely to have been smaller than in 1961. Private consumption in real terms probably rose by about 3 ½ per cent, rather more than in 1961.

6. There has been a large increase in government current expenditure during the financial year 1962-63, mainly as a result of higher levels of remuneration for public services, increased pensions and welfare services, and extra expenditure on agricultural supports. Despite the increase in taxes on beer, spirits and tobacco announced in last year's budget, and the subsequent further increase on the duty on tobacco in June 1962, Exchequer returns for the first nine months of the 1962-63 fiscal year point to the possibility of a small current deficit.

7. On the capital side, there is likely to have been a further substantial rise in public sector investment expenditure during 1962. No statistics are available on this point as yet, but the public capital programme published in April 1962 was for nearly £67 million, an increase of 17 per cent by value and perhaps some 8 per cent in volume over the previous year's level.

8. The rise in fixed investment expenditure at constant prices in 1962 as a whole is estimated to have been 8 per cent compared with 15 per cent in 1961. The building and construction sectors (residential and industrial building and construction) probably rose more than expenditure on plant and equipment. The decline in the rate of growth of investment in 1962, compared with that achieved in 1961, is probably exaggerated by the bunching together of a number of large items — the purchase of jet aircraft and other transport equipment — in the figures for 1961.

9. There was an exceptionally large increase in agricultural and non-agricultural stocks, estimated at £11 million, last year. The former was caused by the need for farmers to build up their stocks of cattle again after the heavy exports of live cattle and the acceleration of the bovine tuberculosis eradication programme.

10. Because of limited availabilities in 1962, there was a fall in exports of live cattle and beef of £12 million, which exceeded the fall in total exports of £7 million. But demand factors seem to have been the major reason for the slower rate of growth of 3 per cent, compared

with 7 per cent, in exports of non-agricultural raw materials and manufactured products last year. Conditions on the British market, the largest foreign outlet for Irish industry, became progressively less buoyant during 1962. But, it is probable that the rise in the prices of some manufactured products also affected exports unfavourably.

TABLE 1. RESOURCES AND EXPENDITURE 1960-1962

£ million, 1954 prices.

	1960	1961	1962 (EST.)
Private consumption	426	437	452
Public consumption	66	69	72
Gross fixed capital formation :			
Total	73	84	91
Stock changes	+ 10	+ 3	+ 11
Exports of good and services	223	255	250
Total use of resources	798	848	876
Less : Imports of goods and services	238	266	276
Equals : Gross National Product (at market prices)	560	582	600

Source : Irish Submission to the O.E.C.D.

b) *Trends in output and employment*

11. Including building and construction, industrial production probably rose less than in 1961, that is by about 6-7 per cent. The rate of growth of the output of manufacturing industries fell to 5 per cent, little more than half the increase which took place in 1961. In the fourth quarter it was 6 1/2 per cent higher than a year earlier. There was a small decline, of about 1 per cent, in the output of the mining, quarrying and turf industries due to bad weather conditions which held up turf production during the summer months, and a fall in the output of copper ore. But it is likely that the building and construction sector raised its output by over 12 per cent.

12. As to agriculture, the quality of the wheat harvest was impaired by heavy rain, and imports of wheat will be required in above-average amounts during the 1962-63 agricultural year. Other cereal crops were affected less. There was an increase in production of dairy products and of sheep, mutton and pigs. But there was a decline in cattle sales compared with the exceptionally high figure in the previous year. As a result of the building-up of fresh stocks of younger and breeding animals, cattle stocks in June 1962 were marginally higher than a year earlier.

13. The slowing down in the rate of increase of output in some industrial sectors was not accompanied by lower labour intake; thus productivity gains were lower. Employment in manufacturing rose by about 3 per cent, or by nearly the same amount as in 1961, but the increase in productivity per man fell to less than 1 ½ per cent, or one-third of the rate of the previous year. It is likely that part of this trend was due to recruitment of labour by new firms which have not yet reached their normal production rate. There is no reason to think that, if external demand conditions improve from now on, the rise in the labour productivity rate will remain at its 1962 level.

14. The biggest expansion of employment last year took place in the building industry, where the labour force may have increased by over 10 per cent. Despite this increase and the fact that the service trades also offered greater job opportunities, it is unlikely that there was much increase in overall employment, as the fall in agriculture is expected to have been substantial.

15. As in previous years, there was a net outflow of emigrants, most of whom went to Britain. But the total (as measured by net outward passenger movements by sea and air) was notably smaller than in 1961 — about 21,000 compared with 27,000. Net emigration was also lower than the annual natural increase in the population (25-26,000). It is likely that the depressed state of the labour market in Britain in 1962 reduced the number of emigrants leaving Ireland.

16. Unemployment figures are not easy to interpret in the case of Ireland, since they include persons waiting to emigrate. However, the annual changes provide some guide to the state of supply and demand on the labour market. In 1962 there was little change in the level of unemployment, which remained at rather less than 6 per cent.

TABLE 2. PRODUCTION TRENDS 1960-1962
PERCENTAGE CHANGE COMPARED WITH PRECEDING YEAR

	1960	1961	1962 (EST.)
Manufacturing	+ 9	+ 9	+ 5
Mining, quarrying and turf	− 13	+ 17	− 1
Building and construction	+ 5	+ 5	+ 12
Agriculture	+ 4	+ 1	+ 1

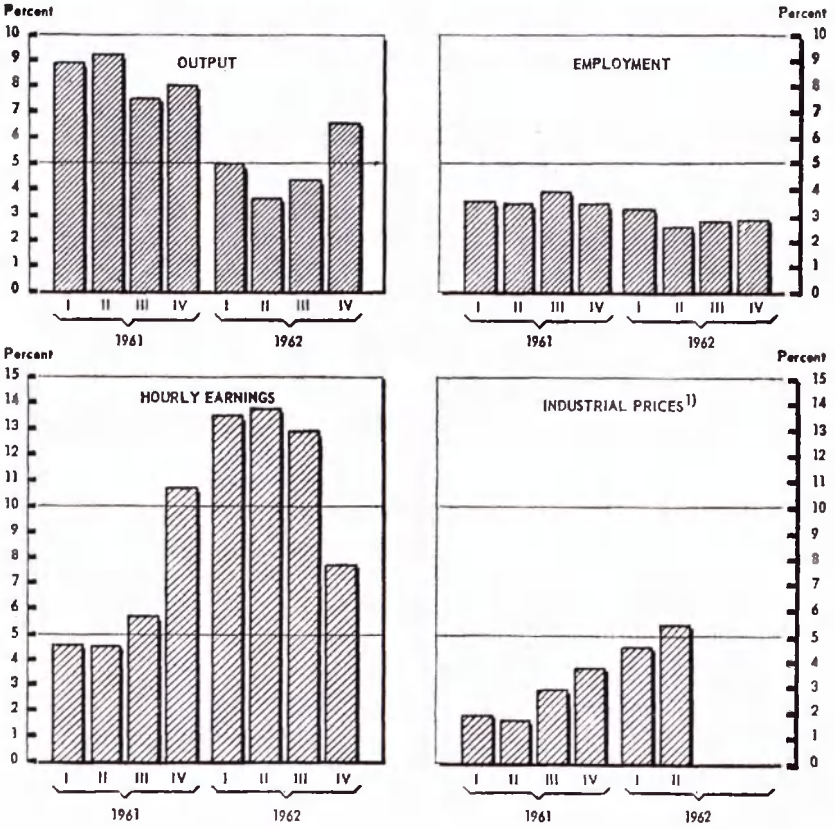
Source: Irish Trade Journal and Statistical Bulletin.

c) *Prices*

17. Prices rose faster in 1962 than during the previous twelve months, the increases being spread over most categories of goods and services.

Diagram 2. OUTPUT AND OTHER INDICATORS IN MANUFACTURING

PERCENTAGE CHANGE OVER CORRESPONDING QUARTER OF PREVIOUS YEAR



1. More highly transformed products.

Source: Irish Trade Journal and Statistical Bulletin.

Consumer prices increased by 4 ¼ per cent for the year as a whole compared with less than 3 per cent in 1961. Changes in indirect taxes in the 1962 Budget, and subsequently, accounted for about one point of the total rise in the index of consumer prices. Food prices rose by about 2 ¼ per cent and prices of manufactures and services also rose.

18. The price index for capital goods was some 4 per cent higher in 1962 reflecting, in particular, increased building costs. Higher wage and salary costs, following the wage round at the end of 1961 and early 1962, brought price levels of manufactured goods under pressure, and there was an increase of about 4 per cent for the year as a whole.

Prices received by farmers rose less than those of other goods and services (2 per cent) so that there was some further deterioration in the terms of trade of agriculture.

TABLE 3. PRICES 1960-1962

PERCENTAGE CHANGE COMPARED WITH PREVIOUS YEAR

	1960	1961	1962 (EST.)
Consumer prices	—	+ 3	+ 4
of which:			
— food prices	− 1	+ 4	+ 2
Wholesale prices of manufactures[1]	+ 2	+ 2	+ 4
Capital goods	+ 2	+ 3	+ 4
Agricultural prices	− 3		+ 2
Imports	+ 2	+ 1	+ 2

1. More elaborately transformed.

Source: Irish Trade Journal and Statistical Bulletin.

d) *Balance of Payments*

19. Complete information is not yet available on the balance of payments in 1962. Provisional estimates suggest that the visible trade deficit reached £100 million, its highest level in the last decade and £18 million greater than in the previous year.[1] But there is likely to have been a substantial increase in net invisible receipts. The current account deficit may have been of the order of £12 million, a deterioration of £13 million compared with 1961.

20. Nevertheless, the reserves[2] rose last year by £9 ½ million. This suggests that there was a further increase in net capital receipts, no doubt mainly for direct investment. But there will probably turn out to have been an increase in the positive errors and omissions item, which is treated as unrecorded current receipts, but part of which may be of a capital nature.

e) *Prospects for 1963*

21. A major stimulant to the economy in recent years has been the growth of exports, particularly of manufactured goods. Part of the slowing-down in the rate of increase in production in 1962 occurred because of less favourable trends in Britain which remains Ireland's largest market for manufactured as well as agricultural products. Inso-

1. Figures as adjusted for balance of payments purposes. Imports valued c.i.f.

2. External assets held by commercial banks (net), central bank and in departmental funds.

TABLE 4. FOREIGN TRADE 1961-1962

£ million.

	1961				1962			
	1ST QTR.	2ND QTR.	3RD QTR.	4TH QTR.	1ST QTR.	2ND QTR.	3RD QTR.	4TH QTR.
EXPORTS :								
Total	42.6	42.0	48.6	47.2	43.0	38.6	45.7	46.1
of which :								
live animals	13.6	11.0	16.5	14.2	13.9	9.2	13.1	...
food, drink and tobacco	14.4	15.3	16.8	16,2	13.4	13.8	16.7	...
other domestic exports	13.4	14.5	13.8	15.5	14.3	14.4	14.4	...
Re-exports	1.2	1.2	1.6	1.3	1.5	1.3	1.5	...
IMPORTS :								
Total	65.8	67.4	62.3	65.8	67.3	67.3	64.7	74.4
of which :								
capital goods	9.1	9.9	6.7	7.7	8.8	9.6	8.2	...
consumption goods	13.5	13.1	12.1	14.1	14.0	14.1	11.8	...
materials for further production	40.6	40.6	40.4	41.4	41.5	40.6	41.8	...
unclassified	2.6	3.8	3.1	2.6	3.0	3.0	2.9	...

Source : Irish Trade Journal and Statistical Bulletin.

TABLE 5. BALANCE OF PAYMENTS

£ million.

	1960	1961	1962 (EST.)
Trade balance	− 73.7	− 81.8	− 100
Tourism and travel	+ 27.2	+ 30.5	
Emigrants remittances, etc.	+ 13.0	+ 13.6	
Investment income	+ 12.5	+ 15.3	+ 88
Other invisible items	+ 17.2	+ 17.9	
Errors and omissions[1]	+ 3.0	+ 5.7	
Balance on current transactions	− 0.8	+ 1.2	− 12
Government capital transactions	− 0.8	− 0.8	(+ 21)
Other capital transactions	+ 1.7	+ 14.1	
Change in reserves (+ = increase)	+ 0.1	+ 14.5	(+ 9)

1. Believed to be mainly current in character.

Source : Irish submission to the O.E.C.D.

far as the expansionary measures taken by the British authorities since the end of 1962 begin to take effect this year, demand for Irish products should improve. But it is important that any repetition of the loss in the competitiveness of Irish manufactured exports which occurred in 1962 should be avoided. With the temporary shortage of supplies now overcome, a higher level of cattle and beef exports can be expected this year, although the exceptionally high level of 1961 is unlikely to be repeated.

22. Internally, a further substantial increase in gross fixed capital formation is probable this year. The capital expenditure of the public sector is rising regularly, and the years ahead are likely to see increasing programmes for education, housing and transport. As to private productive investment, there are no indications of any slackening at present, and the improved fiscal incentives granted last year by the State to encourage businessmen to invest, taken with those of earlier years, should show increasing results.

23. So far, the large rise in earnings in the non-agricultural sector during 1962 has not been translated into any very significant higher level of demand for imports. But the rise in savings that marked 1961 and 1962 may slacken this year, and there may be a more rapid increase in consumption — particularly if, as is likely, agricultural incomes improve. In such an event, the trend in import demand will need to be watched carefully.

24. For the moment, however, the rise in imports remains based mainly upon demand for capital equipment and raw materials and, with the prospects for an improvement in exports during 1963, net receipts on invisible and capital account should again be sufficiently buoyant to take care of the likely trade deficit this year. In any case, Ireland's exchange reserves are high enough to enable moderate overall deficits to be faced in support of the economic development of the country.

II. Major Policy Issues

25. With a very active development policy on the part of the authorities for some years now, the Irish economy has already achieved substantial results. The growth of G.N.P. has been very notably higher than the average during the post-war period, exports have acquired a new dynamism and productive investment has risen quite fast. But certain particularly favourable factors have been operating during recent years and it is important that growth should be able to continue even though some of them are likely to weaken from now on. This is notably the case as regards the level of protection granted to Irish industry on the home market, and the degree of unused industrial capacity and infrastructure which is now smaller than when the more rapid growth started some four years ago.

26. To be sustainable, the growth of the economy needs to be export-oriented, in the sense that current receipts from abroad keep pace with the faster growth of payments, notably for imports, likely in future. The expansion of exports of manufactured goods is probably the most important single change in the growth pattern of the economy in recent years. To sustain it will call for continued adaptation of Irish industry. And cost competitiveness will have to be maintained.

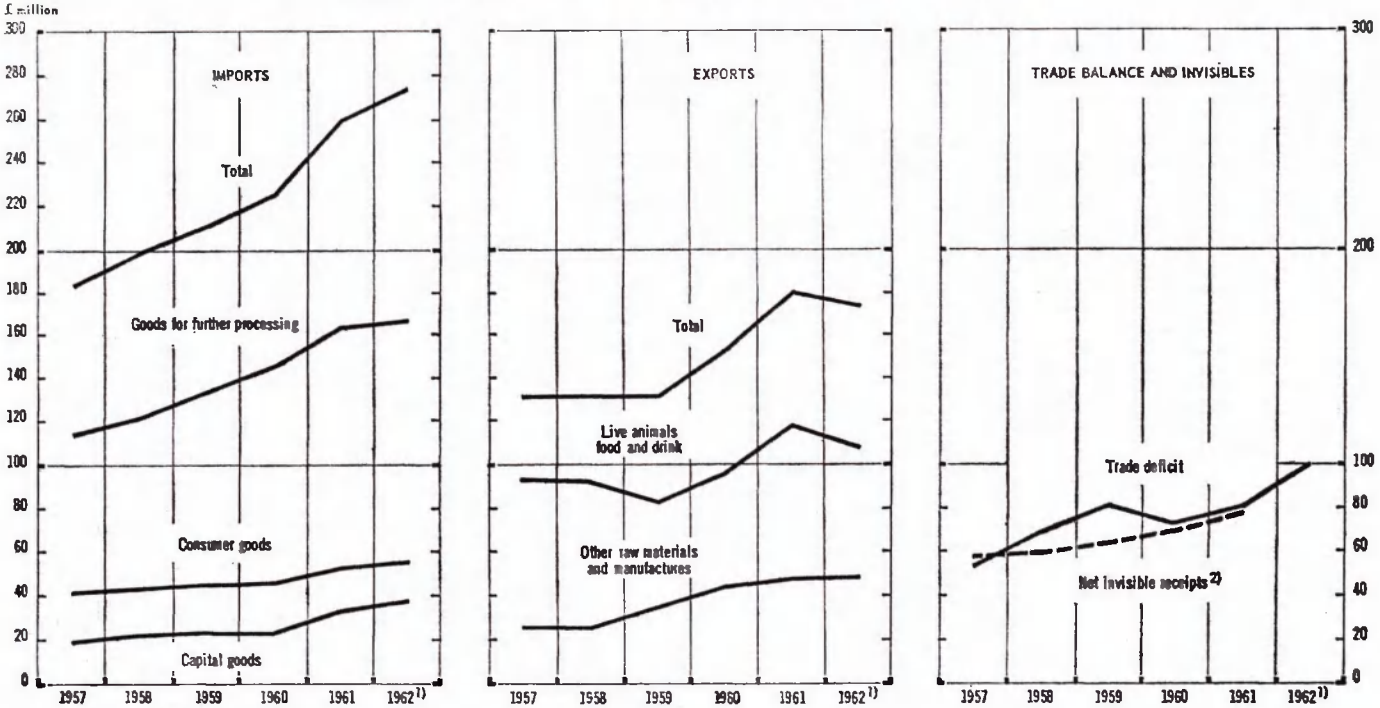
27. But agriculture also will have substantially to contribute to growth, and to balancing the external accounts. Over one-quarter of output — and two-thirds of exports — come from agriculture; the country's biggest natural resource is grassland, and meat and dairy products will continue to bulk large. It is important that Ireland's efforts to increase production and exports should not be frustrated by restrictions imposed upon agricultural imports by the major industrial countries.

a) *Balance of Payments*

28. It has already been noted that Ireland's external reserves have risen during the last four years of more rapid growth and now stand at a high level. Moreover, the structure of exports is becoming more broadly based both product-wise and market-wise, whilst imports of consumer goods have risen only moderately. The goal of a balance on external accounts need not be interpreted too narrowly in terms of either an annual overall balance or a predetermined level of the trade balance so long as the underlying trend is clearly in the right direction. A deterioration of the balance which, largely the result of exceptional factors, was expected to correct itself in a reasonable period of time, should justify drawings on the country's reserves. The unfavourable consequences of a premature check to growth on the confidence of the business community would outweigh any short-term considerations stemming from the reserve position. The willingness and ability of the private sector to adjust its methods to freer trading conditions during the years ahead can only be maintained in a climate of continued expansion. In this connection, it may need to be considered whether the traditional attitude of the commercial banks whereby they seek to maintain a ratio of about 30 per cent between external assets and the level of deposits is not now unduly restrictive.

29. Whatever role Ireland plays in the European trading system of the future, the general trend on world markets over the coming years will be towards lower tariffs. The alternative for Ireland would be to return to protectionism. This policy did not enable the economy to achieve a satisfactory rate of growth in the past. Moreover, the home market is already well supplied by indigenous industry and it is unlikely that any further expansion of industry on the scale required to keep emigration within acceptable proportions could be achieved otherwise than on the basis of higher exports.

Diagram 3. FOREIGN TRADE AND INVISIBLE EARNINGS



1. Estimated.
2. Excluding balance unaccounted for (+ £6 million in 1961). In 1962 net invisibles plus balance unaccounted for was £88 million.

Source : Irish Trade Journal and Statistical Bulletin.

30. The prospect of a progressive lowering of tariffs can constitute a valuable spur to Irish industry even though, as is noted elsewhere in this survey, it raises difficult problems of transition. But it will call for a growing level of export receipts, on visible and invisible account, as the present tendency for imports to rise rather faster than G.N.P. will be accentuated. In order to make a start in reducing the present tariff levels the government reduced non-revenue industrial tariffs unilaterally by 10 per cent on 1st January, 1963; a further cut is to take place on 1st January, 1964. An announcement has also been made of the intention to remove the remaining quantitative restrictions on imports of industrial goods and to substitute customs duties for them; certain duty-free licensing provisions will operate.

b) *Adaptation Problems in Industry*

31. The need to adapt the structure of industry to freer trading conditions has been given increasing weight in government industrial policy in recent years. The first major step was the setting up, in 1961, of a Committee for Industrial Organisation (C.I.O.), a tripartite body with representatives of management, labour and the public sector, whose task is to indicate the framework within which policy should be designed.

32. The method so far followed has been to assign a team of investigators to each branch of industry with the task of making a systematic survey of the problems and needs of the industry in the event of a progressive reduction of protective tariffs. So far five reports have been published (cotton textiles, leather footwear, paper and paperboard, motor vehicles assembly and fertilizers) and eighteen others are nearing completion.

33. The first reports — which cover sectors not necessarily typical of Irish industry, in particular the more modern branches — indicate that sizeable adjustments will be called for if domestic production is to compete with imports. The most extreme case is the motor-assembly industry which employs some 2,500 workers and supplies over 90 per cent of all cars sold in Ireland. In the absence of protection this industry would lose its raison d'être. But such extreme cases of the need for reconversion appear to be rare. The problems common to most branches are the small average size of firms, which constitutes a handicap as regards the finance of modernisation and market research, and the insufficient stress placed on styling and design. It is hoped that some of these problems will be solved on a co-operative basis by agreement between firms, especially on market research and design.

34. The C.I.O. has also put out four interim reports on general aspects of industrial policy — State aid for adaptation purposes, joint export marketing, the setting-up of Adaptation Councils, and industrial grants. Virtually all the recommendations which involved Govern-

ment action have already been adopted. Thus the scope of industrial grants has been widened so as to cover a switch from one type of activity to another, which would not otherwise qualify. Loans for re-equipment in the same field of activity have been introduced and firms have the choice of a loan or a 25 per cent grant towards the cost of re-equipment. Initial allowances for tax purposes were doubled last year and are now 20 per cent on industrial buildings and 40 per cent on plant and equipment. The State Export Board will receive funds enabling it to investigate schemes for establishing joint export arrangements. Funds for making grants to Adaptation Councils have been made available. And changes in emphasis are being considered in the regional allocation of development assistance; the desirability of fostering development in selected centres is being studied in the context of the second programme.

35. The establishment of Adaptation Councils for a number of industries is under way. It is intended that they should consist of small representative groups of manufacturers' delegates with at least one independent member, and their object is to encourage a common approach to the problems of each branch of industry. Neither the government nor the trade unions will be represented on these Councils. But it is hoped that the trade unions will establish permanent advisory bodies to be consulted by the Councils on problems affecting workers and working conditions.

36. A special branch of the Department of Industry and Commerce to be known as the Industrial Reorganisation Branch was created in October 1962. Its task will be to follow through the implementation of the recommendations of the C.I.O. for each industry.

c) *Agricultural Problems*

37. Parallel to the work of the C.I.O., surveys of the agricultural sector have been in progress since 1961. Study groups representative of producers, processing industries, users and government have been examining the implications for certain commodities of freer trading conditions. Groups have been formed dealing with cereals, milk products, cattle, sheep, beef and mutton, pigs, poultry and eggs, and horticulture. In addition, surveys of the four principal processing industries — dairy products, processed meat, cereals and pigmeat — have been carried out on the line of the C.I.O. surveys. Three of the four team reports have been completed and are expected to be published shortly. Special market studies have been undertaken of trends in demand in Europe for Irish agricultural products.

38. Considerable scope seems to exist for the development of food-processing industries. But they will have to base their activities firmly on exporting as the existing high nutrition levels in Ireland leave little room for any rapid growth of home demand. Ireland's export pros-

pects will not, of course, depend solely upon considerations of cost, quality and marketability but also upon the policy decisions taken by the major importing countries, particularly in Europe. At present, Ireland has free access to the British market, but an expansion of agricultural exports on the scale likely to be necessary will probably call for a diversification of export markets, in particular on the Continent.

39. Adequate access to foreign markets will be of little avail if it is not accompanied by continued efforts by Irish producers. The better prices received for high quality bacon and for Irish butter on the British market as a result of improved marketing and the adoption of branded products illustrate the success that such efforts may meet. The favourable cost position of Irish producers is often based on the fact that low real incomes offset low productivity, particularly in the west of Ireland. It has been estimated that pasturelands are capable of supporting a 50 per cent increase in cattle stocks. The rate of increase in productivity per worker in agriculture, about 3 per cent annually in the last decade, is not high by comparison with other O.E.C.D. Member countries and the scope for improvement should be substantial. But a higher rate of growth of output per man, upon which a rising level of real incomes in agriculture depends, will probably call for a faster rate of migration of workers to other pursuits. If emigration is to be kept within acceptable limits, it will be necessary for the rate of job creation in non-agricultural occupations to be kept at a high level.

40. Agricultural policy in recent years has emphasised the acceleration of the programme for the eradication of bovine tuberculosis, which was urgently necessary in view of more stringent controls by Britain on the import of live cattle, Ireland's largest single export product. This programme, which has cost the authorities over £26 million since 1958, is probably now at its peak. Fifteen of the twenty-six counties have now been cleared and a further five will be free of the disease by May 1963. Savings in public expenditure under this heading should provide room for an expansion of other forms of agricultural improvements.

d) *The Programme for Economic Expansion*

41. A very considerable role in the upsurge in economic activity has been played by the first Programme for Economic Expansion, launched in 1958 and due to end next year. It has reshaped public expenditure to direct it more towards productive investment. And it has helped to create a climate of public opinion favourable to growth. A second programme is being prepared by the authorities.

42. Details of this Programme are not yet available. The heavy dependence of the Irish economy upon export markets and the large share of agriculture in G.N.P. make it particularly difficult to fix precise quantitative targets for the major sectors of the economy. But the

Government's intention is to make use of the results of enquiries carried out by the survey teams in the industrial and agricultural sectors and to incorporate them in an overall programme which will be of a more quantitative nature than the first Programme. In this connection, the Prime Minister has announced that Ireland accepts the overall growth target of an increase of 50 per cent in G.N.P. by 1970 adopted by the Council of Ministers of the O.E.C.D. in 1961.

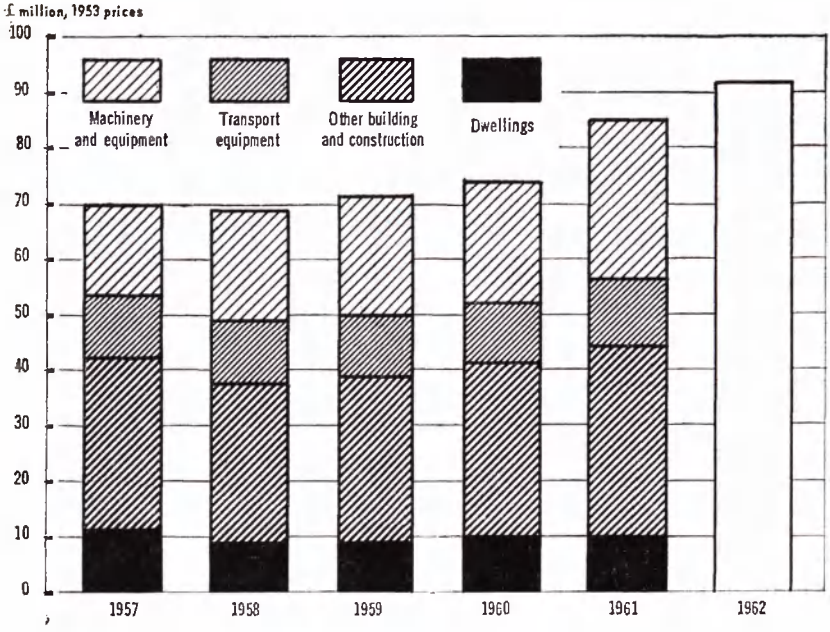
43. If any fairly rapid dismantling of tariffs takes place in the next few years, the need to reconvert some firms, and even whole branches of industry, may tend to slow down the overall rate of growth during the transitional period. This being the case, it is essential that the new sense of urgency and of confidence in the private sector should be maintained. The problems of reconversion and re-adaptation will be easier to solve insofar as they take place in a climate of expansion; and opposition to needed changes will, by the same token, be lessened. Both the business community and labour must be helped to realise that, whatever the immediate prospect for Ireland entering a wider trading group than the present preferential system with Britain, the long-term prospect is irrevocably one of lower protection on the home market.

44. A relatively ambitious growth target for the 1960's will imply a substantial increase in the ratio of gross fixed capital formation to G.N.P., which at present is only 15 per cent. The expansion of the industrial sector will call for additional investment, and so will the re-conversion of certain activities. A higher rate of investment in agriculture appears to be called for. And it is likely that investment on infrastructure and housing will be making increasing calls on available savings.

45. Up to the present, the increase in investment, both in the private and public sectors, has not given rise to any notable financing problems. But these may become more important. First, there is a problem of overall balance between the growth of private consumption and the growth of investment. The growth of the former has been moderate in recent years and the personal savings ratio has increased — particularly in 1961 and 1962 after the large increase in nominal incomes, but there is need for a further improvement to finance the increase in investment required.

46. A second problem concerning the raising of the investment ratio relates to the willingness of producers to invest. The system of tax exemptions and of grants and loans by the State is now quite extensive. Indeed, it may be considered that a limit is being approached beyond which the assistance extended would run the risk of encouraging enterprises which would be unable to stand on their own feet after a reasonable period of adjustment. A healthy willingness to invest depends, fundamentally, on the creation and maintenance of a climate of optimism. In some sectors the arrival of foreign firms can provide

Diagram 4. FIXED CAPITAL FORMATION BY TYPE OF ASSET (1957-62)



Source: National Income and Expenditure, 1961.

a stimulus — and has, indeed, already begun to do so. Elsewhere, in some branches of the food-processing industry for example, public enterprise is playing a pioneering role.

47. A third problem which may be met with in the attempt to raise investment expenditure is that of channelling savings from those who save to those willing to invest. At the short-term end, it appears that Ireland possesses a well-developed banking system although, because of the close links with the United Kingdom, interest rates may not be free to adjust to the probably lower level required by Irish conditions at times when money is dear and tight in Britain. There are a number of specialised financial institutions, sponsored by the State, for granting longer-term credits to farmers and industrialists. And, as already noted, a wide range of grants and loans is available from public funds for development and reconversion. The largest financial intermediary in the long-term end of the market is the Government itself through its grants and loans which are financed, inter alia, by annual issues of long-term bonds on the capital market.

48. These arrangements compensate to some extent for the absence of any broadly based capital market, in Ireland. But it may become

necessary to encourage private industry to finance a larger part of its development through issues of shares and debentures. At present, Irish residents have large holdings of securities abroad, mainly in Britain (with whom all transactions take place on a fully convertible basis). Wider investment opportunities at home could induce a change in Irish investors' attitudes as regards investing in Ireland or in Britain, with consequent beneficial effects both to the balance of payments and to the supply of savings at home.

III. Conclusions

49. The growth of the Irish economy during the period covered by the first Programme for Economic Expansion is likely to turn out substantially better than the 2 per cent annual average originally envisaged. In the four years of the period which have already elapsed, the rate has averaged some 4 1/2 per cent; the slightly slower growth of 1962 was probably due mainly to external factors, and there are grounds for hoping that 1963 will witness something like a 4 per cent increase.

50. The expansion process has included a welcome growth of fixed capital investment and of exports. Thanks to the latter, a balance on current external account has been maintained and the reserves have in fact risen substantially.

51. These circumstances would make highly appropriate the introduction of a new expansion programme aiming at a growth rate that will make important inroads into the problems of providing higher employment outside the agricultural sector. The execution of the new programme may lead, from time to time, to some running down of the reserves. This is a prospect which the Irish economy could face without alarm. Experience in many Member countries in recent years testifies to the importance of allowing a certain continuity in the growth process if the private sector is to take appropriate investment and re-organisation decisions — which are of vital importance to the Irish balance of payments in the longer-term.

52. But the ability of the authorities to pursue an ambitious expansionary policy untrammelled by the need to resort to stop-and-go policies can be seriously limited if money incomes are pushed up excessively. And a repetition of the sort of wage round that occurred at the end of 1961 and in the early months of 1962 could easily compel the authorities to fall back on such policies, thereby seriously weakening the more dynamic forces that have developed in the Irish economy in recent years. This, of course, requires increased appreciation, by both sides of industry, of the true scope for higher incomes at any given time. In recognition of this the Government recently published a white paper emphasizing that an increase in output is the only safe basis for an increase in incomes and calling for general restraint in incomes until

national production had risen sufficiently. The white paper stated that the Government deemed it necessary that departments and state sponsored organisations should not accede for the present to any claims for increases in wages and salaries which would arouse expectations of similar increases in other employments. In the longer run the authorities hope that it will be possible to move towards a conscious acceptance of some general standard for income increases. It appears that public opinion is becoming increasingly aware of this problem and of the need to find solutions for it.

53. A major assumption on which the first Programme for Economic Expansion was based was that the Irish economy needed to be more outward-looking. And the recommendations of the C.I.O., which will certainly play an important role in the design of the second programme, are intended to highlight the major problems that Irish industry is likely to face in the framework of a freer international economy, and the directions in which those problems may best be solved. The solutions envisaged imply many changes, the need for which will not always be independently recognised by the parties to whom the diagnosis applies. For obvious reasons, the diagnosis has tended to be expressed in terms of the imperatives emerging from Irish adhesion to an enlarged Common Market. But it must be remembered that they would be little, if at all, less categorical were such adhesion not to be secured. Government policy, very rightly, is based on the realisation that the further development of the Irish economy must, largely, rely on industries with a strong orientation towards foreigns markets. These industries are unlikely to find suitable outlets unless Ireland is able, wholeheartedly, to join in the movement towards the reduction of tariffs and other trade barriers. This will entail important modifications of the structure of both industry and agriculture and the attitude of employers and workers towards the framework within which production takes place.

54. In Ireland's circumstances, maintaining a satisfactory rate of overall growth will call not only for a rapid expansion of industrial exports but an increase in exports of agricultural products. To achieve this it is clear that drastic efforts to increase productivity and improve marketing techniques will have to be supplemented by measures on the part of other countries to reduce the existing obstacles to an expansion of international trade.

STATISTICAL ANNEX

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TABLE I. EXPENDITURE ON GROSS NATIONAL PRODUCT

	1954	1955	1956	1957	1958	1959	1960	1961	1962
a) **£ MILLION AT CURRENT PRICES**									
1. Consumers' expenditure	389.6	419.7	422.4	430.9	454.9	464.4	494.3	521	559
2. Public authorities' current expenditure	64.0	66.1	70.2	69.0	72.0	75.4	78.8	85	92
3. Gross fixed capital formation	85.2	91.1	89.9	78.6	78.6	79.9	85.1	101	114
of which : private	72.1	76.8	75.6	67.0	66.9	67.3	72.3	86	..
public	13.1	14.3	14.3	11.6	11.7	12.6	12.8	15	..
4. Increase in stocks and work in progress	− 5.4	+ 9.7	− 7.9	− 6.6	− 7.7	+ 23.0	+ 11.5	+ 3	+ 12
5. Exports of goods and services[1]	186.4	186.2	183.2	205.3	209.1	217.1	241.6	277	276
6. Total use of resources	719.8	772.8	757.8	777.2	806.9	859.8	911.3	987	1,053
7. *Less :* Imports of goods and services[1]	202.5	232.5	208.7	208.0	221.9	237.9	255.2	290	302
8. Gross national product at market prices	517.3	540.3	549.1	569.2	585.0	621.9	656.1	697	751
b) **£ MILLION AT CONSTANT (1954) PRICES**									
1. Consumers' expenditure	389.6	408.8	396.1	387.6	391.8	401.1	425.6	437	452
2. Public authorities' current expenditure	64.0	63.9	65.2	62.2	61.9	64.2	65.8	69	72
3. Gross fixed capital formation	85.2	88.7	82.7	69.3	68.4	70.1	73.3	84	91
of which : private	72.1	74.7	69.6	59.1	58.3	59.0	62.4	72	..
public	13.1	14.0	13.1	10.2	10.1	11.1	10.9	12	..
4. Increase in stocks and work in progress	− 5.4	+ 8.9	− 8.0	− 6.2	− 7.2	+ 20.4	+ 10.1	+ 3	+ 11
5. Exports of goods and services[1]	186.4	181.0	180.6	198.1	194.8	197.2	222.5	255	250
6. Total use of resources	719.8	751.3	716.6	711.0	709.7	753.0	797.3	848	876
7. *Less :* Imports of goods and services[1]	202.5	225.0	197.7	187.1	206.1	225.3	237.8	266	276
8. Gross national product at market prices	517.3	526.3	518.9	523.9	503.6	527.7	559.5	582	600

1. Including income payments to and from rest of world.
Source : Irish submission to O.E.C.D.

Table II. PRODUCTION

	1954	1955	1956	1957	1958	1959	1960	1961	1962
Agricultural Output:									
1. Volume of total output[1] *(1953 = 100)*	99.6	101.9	103.8	108.5	96.9	103.9	108.6	110.6	
of which:									
2. Livestock and livestock products	103.4	104.5	104.9	108.4	105.6	107.4	111.1	117.5	
3. Crop production	97.5	98.7	103.2	114.5	86.7	109.9	114.5	115.7	
4. Cattle numbers *(thousands)* (mid-year count)	4,504	4,483	4,537	4,417	4,466	4,684	4,741	4,713	4,742
5. Sheep numbers *(thousands)* (mid-year count)	3,113	3,269	3,439	3,720	4,174	4,412	4,314	4,528	4,671
6. Pig numbers *(thousands)* (mid-year count)	958	799	747	900	948	852	951	1,056	1,111
7. Milk production *(million gallons)*	523	520	544	575	561	532	570	594	
8. Wheat production *(thousand metric tons)*	497	406	433	521	351	369	469	470	
9. Barley production *(thousand metric tons)*	179	250	319	389	336	460	442	515	
10. Potato production *(thousand metric tons)*	2,284	2,148	2,649	2,374	1,761	2,634	1,829	2,145	
Industrial Output:									
11. Index of industrial production, transportable goods *(1953 = 100)*	103	108	105	105	107	118	126	138	144
12. — mining and quarrying	114	132	143	150	115	181	157	190	188
13. — manufacturing,	103	106	104	103	106	115	124	135	142
of which:									
14. — food, drink and tobacco	94	95	92	91	92	96	99	107	
15. — textiles	108	114	122	126	128	138	161	170	
16. — metal products and engineering	124	130	113	115	124	142	162	181	
17. Electricity output *(million kWh)* (monthly average)	117	128	137	142.7	154.8	168.2	186.5	197.1	217.5

1. Net output, adjusted for stock changes, excluding turf.

Source: Irish Trade Journal and Statistical Bulletin, O.E.C.D. General Statistics, O.E.C.D. Agricultural and Food Statistics.

TABLE III. EMPLOYMENT AND OTHER ECONOMIC INDICATORS

	1958	1959	1960	1961	1962	1961				1962			
						1ST QTR.	2ND QTR.	3RD QTR.	4TH QTR.	1ST QTR.	2ND QTR.	3RD QTR.	4TH QTR.
1. Total employed population *(thousands)*[1]	1,121	1,112	1,113	1,119									
of which:													
2. Agriculture, forestry and fishing[1]	429	420	413	409									
3. Transportable goods[2]	150.3	153.1	160.6	166.9	170.5	163.3	167.2	168.2	169.0	167.8	169.6	171.7	173.0
4. Construction[1]	65	61	63	64									
5. Unemployment (registered) *(thousands)*	64.8	60.5	52.7	46.8	46.5	58.6	45.9	35.4	47.0	56.7	45.6	36.1	47.7
6. Unemployment as percentage of insured labour force *(per cent)*	8.6	8.0	6.7	5.7	5.7	6.9	5.8	4.8	5.4	6.7	5.8	5.0	5.4
7. Net outward passenger movement by sea and air[3] *(thousands)*	40	39	43	27	21	28	+ 7	31	+ 26	34	+ 23	35	+ 25
8. Average hours worked per week in transportable goods industries *(number)*[4]	45.1	45.4	45.4	44.6	44.5	44.7	44.9	44.6	44.5	43.8	43.9	44.5	44.7
9. Value of average weekly retail sales *(1961 = 100)*										96	106	108	118
10. New private cars, registered for first time *(thousands)*	19.1	22.9	27.9	28.6	31.7[5]	7.3	8.9	6.7	5.7	8.6[5]	9.8[5]	7.2[5]	6.1[5]

1. Figures are for early April.
2. Quarterly figures are for March, June, September and December. Annual figures are averages.
3. « + » indicates a net inward movement.
4. Annual figures are for October (1958 to 1960) and September (1961 and 1962); quarterly figures relate to March, June, September and December.
5. Provisional.

Source: Irish Trade Journal and Statistical Bulletin, and O.E.C.D. General Statistics.

Table IV. PRICES AND WAGES

	1958	1959	1960	1961	1962	1961				1962			
						1st Qtr.	2nd Qtr.	3rd Qtr.	4th Qtr.	1st Qtr.	2nd Qtr.	3rd Qtr.	4th Qtr.
1. Consumer prices[1] (mid-August) *(1953 = 100)*	116.5	116.5	117.0	120.2	125.3	118.9	120.3	120.5	121.1	123.3	126.5	125.9	125.6
2. Of which, food prices[1] (mid-August *(1953 = 100)*	118.6	118.1	116.5	120.6	123.2	119.8	121.7	120.3	120.5	122.5	126.1	123.1	121.1
3. Wholesale prices[1] *(1953 = 100)*	113.5	113.5	112.9	114.7		113.7	114.4	114.3	115.0	117.2	119.1	118.6	
4. Agricultural prices[1] *(1953 = 100)*	102.5	102.4	99.6	100.0	101.6	100.6	99.5	95.8	101.0	103.8	102.3	99.3	100.6
5. Store cattle prices[1] (1-2 year olds) (Average monthly prices at fairs, £ *per head)*	42.4	41.1	34.8	36.3	39.3	33.1	37.2	37.0	35.9	40.4	40.4	39.3	38.2
6. Industrial prices[1] *(1953 = 100)*	112.3	112.8	114.4	116.4		115.2	115.8	116.6	117.5	118.9	120.8	121.5	
of which :													
— simply transformed	104.8	105.4	105.9	106.1		106.2	106.4	106.0	105.4	105.8	107.3	107.5	
— more elaborately transformed	115.0	115.5	117.4	120.2		118.5	119.3	120.5	121.9	123.7	125.8	126.7	
7. Average hourly earnings in transportable goods industries[2] *(Oct. 1953 = 100)*	124.8	128.4	137.3	145.3	163.3	140.2	143.4	145.3	154.7	158.1	163.3	164.4	167.3
8. Hourly wage rates in agriculture[3] *(1953 = 100)*	118.7	126.1	131.0	134.7	150.3	134.7	134.7	134.7	142.0	142.0	150.3		

1. Quarterly figures for February, May, August and November.
2. Annual figures for September, others for March, June, September and December.
3. Annual figure relate to July, others to March, June, September and December.

Source : Irish Trade Journal and Statistical Bulletin.

TABLE V. MONEY AND BANKING

	1957	1958	1959	1960	1961	1962	1961 1ST QTR.	1961 2ND QTR.	1961 3RD QTR.	1961 4TH QTR.	1962 1ST QTR.	1962 2ND QTR.	1962 3RD QTR.	1962 4TH QTR.
1. Currency circulation[1] *(£ thousand)* (average of Saturdays)	78,350	80,499	79,868	79,132	84,040	90,117	84,040	82,881	85,284	90,197	90,117	89,040	90,709	95,482
2. Discount rate of Central Bank[2] *(per cent)*	6	4 1/4	4 1/4	4 5/8	5 9/16	3 55/64	4 3/4	4 5/8	6 3/4	5 9/16	4 45/64	4 4/32	3 15/16	3 55/64
3. Price of 3.50 per cent Exchequer Bonds[3] *(per £ 100 stock)*	81.0	81.9	86.6	85.1	82.6	84.1	82.6	83.6	82.3	82.2	82.0	83.2	84.0	87.4
4. Price index number of ordinary stocks and shares *(1953 = 100)*	94.7	94.5	125.5	157.9	187.0	210.9	173.0	191.3	191.4	192.3	205.6	213.3	204.8	219.9
COMMERCIAL BANKS:[2]														
5. Current accounts *(£ million)*	116.3	124.5	129.3	138.6	147.9	160.9	127.1	139.6	135.4	148.0	134.5	147.7	147.8	160.9
6. Deposit accounts *(£ million)*	190.2	197.8	201.9	210.7	226.2	242.4	216.3	216.4	222.6	226.2	233.2	235.7	238.8	242.4
7. Bills *(£ million)*	16.0	9.4	6.4	6.7	13.8	13.0	6.8	13.6	11.2	13.8	10.7	20.8	20.8	13.0
8. Loans and advances *(£ million)*	152.4	156.1	171.9	189.7	199.2	218.7	190.7	191.5	196.3	199.2	202.8	206.5	210.7	218.7
9. Net external assets *(£ million)*	90.5	104.9	103.5	103.6	111.4	115.1	99.9	104.8	106.2	111.4	111.9	113.9	111.9	115.1
10. Ratio of external assets to deposits *(per cent)*	29.5	32.5	31.2	29.7	29.8	28.5	29.1	29.4	29.7	29.8	30.5	29.7	28.9	28.5

1. Annual figures for March, others for March, June, September and December.
2. End of period.
3. Annual figures are monthly averages, quarterly figures are for March, June, September and December.

Source: Quarterly Statistical Bulletin of the Central Bank of Ireland, Irish Trade Journal and Statistical Bulletin.

Table VI. FOREIGN TRADE AND PAYMENTS

	1958	1959	1960	1961	1962	1961				1962			
						1st Qtr.	2nd Qtr.	3rd Qtr.	4th Qtr.	1st Qtr.	2nd Qtr.	3rd Qtr.	4th Qtr.
1. Imports (£ *million*) (monthly average)	16.6	17.7	18.9	21.8	22.8	21.9	22.5	20.8	21.9	22.4	22.4	21.6	24.8
2. Exports (£ *million*) (monthly average)	10.9	10.9	12.7	15.0	14.5	14.2	14.0	16.2	15.7	14.3	12.9	15.2	15.5
3. Trade balance (£ *million*) (monthly average)	− 5.6	− 6.8	− 6.1	− 6.7	− 8.3	− 7.7	− 8.5	− 4.6	− 6.2	− 8.1	− 9.6	− 6.3	− 9.3
4. Volume of imports (*1953 = 100*)	100.2	109.6	114.4	130.9	138.0	133.3	136.1	123.8	130.4	136.0	135.0	131.0	150.0
5. Volume of exports (*1953 = 100*)	114.3	109.6	130.2	155.6	147.0	146.0	143.3	169.1	164.1	147.0	130.0	154.0	158.0
6. Import prices[1] (*1953 = 100*)	107.0	104.7	106.6	107.7	107.0	110.1	109.4	111.7	112.1	109.6	110.9	110.3	110.1
7. Export prices[1] (*1953 = 100*)	100.1	104.0	102.2	101.0	103.0	103.3	104.1	101.4	101.0	102.5	103.8	103.7	103.4
8. Terms of trade[1] (*1953 = 100*)	93.5	99.4	95.9	93.8	96.0	93.8	95.2	90.8	90.2	93.6	93.6	94.0	93.9
9. Total external assets (£ *million*) (end of period)	205.8	210.2	209.9	224.5	234.0	214.0	210.2	209.7	224.5	227.0	225.2	227.6	234.0
of which:													
— Central Bank	87.3	86.8	89.2	95.9	104.3	89.9	88.2	86.5	95.9	95.3	93.4	97.7	104.3
— Associated banks (net)	104.9	103.5	103.6	111.4	115.1	99.9	104.8	106.2	111.4	111.9	113.9	111.9	115.1
— Departmental funds	13.6	19.9	17.1	17.2	14.6	24.2	17.2	17.2	17.2	19.8	17.9	18.0	14.6

1. Quarterly figures are for February, May, August and November.

Source: Irish Trade Journal and Statistical Bulletin, Quarterly Statistical Bulletin of the Central Bank of Ireland.

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